

### Application to remove containers

A request for removal is to be made using Form C&E 1021 in duplicate. Requests for attendances commencing later than 6 pm on normal working days or at any time on a non-working day are to be refused except in exceptional circumstances (See 'Merchants Request' below).

### Removal arrangements

Before a removal request is allowed, an enquiry is to be made with the appropriate Liaison Officer. If suitable arrangements can be made, the request is to be granted and the importer/agent informed. The hard-copy declaration is to be endorsed and the completed original copy of C&E1021 is to be attached. It is to be put in a sealed envelope addressed to the examining officer and handed to the carrier. Duplicate Form C&E 1021 is to be filed locally. If it is not possible to arrange for examination at the private premises, the request is refused, and the importer/agent informed. Examination of the container at the Customs office is then to be called for.

### Sealing of containers

Containers are to be sealed prior to removal. Occasionally, container doors are to be opened before sealing and an external examination of packages at the container doors, sufficient to satisfy the officer that the goods are generally in accordance with those declared, is to be carried out.

### Provision of security

A guarantee or other form of security is not required to cover these removal operations.

## 7.1.10 Examination of containers and goods at private premises

### Examination procedures at private premises

Punctual attendance is to be given by examination officers on all occasions. The officer is to call for the official envelope from the carrier, verify container seals are intact and compare particulars with those advised. Where there is doubt as to whether the hard-copy declaration has been substituted or changed between the import and examination points, the officer is to print off details of the declaration from AIS and make a comparison. In cases of material delay in the arrival of the vehicle, the driver's explanation is to be sought and noted. The container is to be examined carefully. Continuous official presence is to be maintained during unloading. The examination officer is responsible for attending to all clearance functions, including Merchants Request charges. Arrangements to account promptly for any underpayments of duty discovered on examination are to be made with the importer provided there is no suspicion of fraud or gross negligence. Underpayments may be accounted for at the import office if arrangements can be made. In such cases, a copy of the Post Notice presented to the importer is to be noted, attached to the hard-copy declaration and returned to the import office.